

Warehouse Wizard × NetSuite — CFO Brief

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We recommend approving Phase 1 now: 60–96 working days, including testing, project management and contingency, that ends the double entry of every delivery into both Warehouse Wizard and NetSuite. The full programme is 151–237 days over three phases, each approved separately. This brief covers cost, financial controls and the decisions needed from finance; the full proposal holds the operational detail.

The proposal on one page

Today every delivery is keyed twice. The warehouse team receives it into Warehouse Wizard, and someone in the office receives it again into NetSuite. That costs staff time, delays stock becoming available to sell, and creates two sets of numbers that have to be reconciled by hand.

The change: goods are received once, on the warehouse floor, in Warehouse Wizard. Warehouse Wizard then posts the receipt into NetSuite automatically. NetSuite stays the system of record for stock valuation, the general ledger, purchasing and financial control. Nothing about how finance works in NetSuite changes.

This direction was agreed by Roget Williams, Wilson Reyes and Jan Roel at the integration meeting on 21 September 2026.

What it removes:

- The second keying of every purchase order, inbound shipment and transfer order receipt
- Manual reconciliation between the warehouse count and NetSuite, replaced by an automated drift report
- Stock sitting in the picking area with no visibility, which Roget described as "a huge red flag"

What stays with finance: rates, landed cost (duty, freight, insurance) and vendor bills are still confirmed in NetSuite by the payables team. Warehouse Wizard records quantities only; it never changes a price or a cost.

Is it all possible? Yes. One part — completing a receipt against an inbound shipment, used for every imported container — needs a small piece of code inside NetSuite, about 2–4 days of Jan Roel's time. It is scheduled into Phase 1.

Cost and phasing

Effort is in working days of development, including testing, documentation, project management and a 15% contingency. The contract day rate is not included; apply the agreed rate.

Phase	What it delivers	Working days	Cost at agreed rate	Recommendation
Phase 1 — Inbound	One-entry receiving for purchase orders, inbound shipments and transfer orders; Pine and Lower Estate brought into Warehouse Wizard; beta sandbox and safe cutover	60–96		Approve now
Phase 2 — Outbound	Sales order picking from NetSuite, units of measure, partial pallets, picking-area visibility, scan-verified picking, transfer despatch	58–92		Approve in principle; schedule after Phase 1 is live
Phase 3 — Extended	Customer returns, bin-level replenishment, nightly reconciliation report, optional finance interim account	33–49		Review after Phase 2
Total		151–237		

Cost = working days × agreed day rate. The ranges are wide on purpose: 22 questions to Simplex's team are still open, and the contingency covers them. Answering the five blocking questions will narrow Phase 1 before work starts.

Phase 1 alone meets the objective. Phases 2 and 3 are improvements, and each can be declined without affecting what Phase 1 delivers.

Not included in these figures

- **Jan Roel's NetSuite time** — about 2–4 days for the inbound shipment service, plus smaller tasks: the receiving report change, bin creation and sandbox setup.
- **Simplex data entry** — defining zones and bins for Pine and Lower Estate in Warehouse Wizard and mirroring them in NetSuite. This is significant clerical work and should be resourced.
- **NetSuite licence changes** — only if extra integration capacity is ever needed. The design avoids this; see the risks below.
- **Converting items to lot-tracked records** in NetSuite, if Simplex chooses that route for expiry tracking.
- **Hardware** — scanners, label printers and tablets for Pine and Lower Estate.
- **Ongoing support and hosting**, which continue under the existing arrangement.

The payback

The return comes from time no longer spent keying receipts twice and reconciling two systems, plus earlier availability of received stock for sale. Simplex holds the figures for hours spent on duplicate entry today; those hours against the Phase 1 cost give the payback period.

Why build this rather than license NetSuite's warehouse module

NetSuite remains the system of record; this is a decision about what runs the warehouse floor. Three capabilities decide it, and each was confirmed by Wilson Reyes, Simplex's inventory systems analyst, during the meeting.

Capability	NetSuite warehouse module	Warehouse Wizard
Pallet tracking	No pallet record exists	Every pallet barcoded and traceable, with location, dimensions and history
Replenishment trigger	Reorder point per location only; cannot see an empty picking aisle when bulk stock is above it	Can trigger replenishment from an individual bin
Picking-area visibility	No ledger or inventory movement until shipment	Live contents and value of the picking area

Cost shape	NetSuite warehouse module	Warehouse Wizard
Licensing	Per user, recurring, grows with the team	Already owned; no per-user warehouse licence
Integration capacity	Heavy use draws on a metered allowance that costs more to raise	Designed to look documents up on demand, keeping usage low
Change	Limited to Oracle's configuration; beyond that, custom NetSuite development	Changed to Simplex's process and terminology as needed
Profile	Recurring operating cost	One-off build on an asset Simplex already owns

The claim we make is a narrow one. Warehouse Wizard is not a replacement for NetSuite. It is a warehouse execution system that fits Simplex's operation more closely than NetSuite's warehouse module, at a lower and less recurring cost, and it makes NetSuite more accurate by feeding it verified quantities with less manual effort.

Financial controls and risks

Area	What happens	Control
Customer invoicing	If NetSuite's "Advanced Shipping" setting is off, recording a shipment also creates the customer invoice automatically	Wilson confirms the setting before any outbound work is designed. No Warehouse Wizard shipment posts to NetSuite until it is confirmed
Receipts and inventory value	Receipts post quantities to NetSuite; NetSuite values them at the purchase order rate	Rates, landed cost and vendor bills stay with payables in NetSuite. Warehouse Wizard never writes a price
Short deliveries	A container may hold fewer units than the purchase order	Recommended policy: record what arrived and flag the difference for the buyer. The open balance stays on the purchase order until closed

Area	What happens	Control
Transfer discrepancies	NetSuite requires a transfer receipt to match what was shipped exactly	Receive in full, then post a separate stock adjustment for any difference — a clear audit trail per variance
Stock adjustments	Count variances post to a general ledger account	Finance nominates the account; nothing posts until it is set
Returns	Returned goods are either restocked or written off to expense	Finance decides who holds write-off authority (Phase 3)
Picked but unshipped stock	NetSuite posts nothing to the ledger until shipment, so picked stock is invisible financially	Phase 2 provides a live picking-area report by product and value. A true interim GL account is possible but means Warehouse Wizard writing journal entries — finance's decision, deferred until the report has been seen
Integration licences	NetSuite meters integration traffic; exceeding the allowance means buying more capacity	Documents are looked up on demand rather than polled every few minutes; usage is monitored
Live system safety	New work could disrupt current operations	All work is built and tested on a separate copy connected to NetSuite's sandbox, whose credentials cannot reach live NetSuite. Live data is never overwritten; every cutover has a rollback plan and a backup
Scope growth	Cost and timeline drift	Each phase is approved separately

Decisions requested from finance

1. **Approve Phase 1** at 60–96 working days, at the agreed day rate.
2. **Approve Phase 2 in principle**, to be confirmed after Phase 1 is live and the estimate has been refined.
3. **Nominate the GL account** that stock adjustments should post to.

4. **Decide the short-delivery policy.** Recommended: record what arrived and flag the difference for the buyer.
5. **Decide on the interim GL account.** Recommended: review the Phase 2 picking-area report first, then decide whether a journal-based interim account is still needed.
6. **Resource Simplex's own tasks:** bin data entry for Pine and Lower Estate, and Jan Roel's 2–4 days of NetSuite development.

The full proposal, including the work breakdown, open questions and delivery plan, accompanies this brief.